

Council Meeting
May 8, 2024
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The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, May 8, 2024, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 5:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Joel Tremblay
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges entered at 5:36 p.m.
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

INTERVIEW COUNCIL CANDIDATES

Mayor Girard began the Council vacancy interview process by noting there were five applicants but Keith Raymond had just pulled their application. Mayor Girard then stated the interviews will be held in alphabetical order.

The first interview held was Mr. Greenrose, Mayor Girard asked a few questions and thanked Mr. Greenrose for their time.

Councilor Limoges entered at 5:36 pm

The next interview was for Benjamin Nelson, Mr. Nelson approached the podium and requested to withdraw his application for the Council vacancy and asked to be considered for the policy committee.

The third interview was with Kevin Tyson, Mayor Girard thanked Mr. Tyson for submitting an application and continued to ask questions.

The last interview was with Mr. Zutter, Mayor Girard again thanked the applicant for taking the time to submit an application for the Council Vacancy, and continued with the interview questions.

Mayor Girard asked for a roll call vote.

Roll call:

Koloski – Zutter

Tremblay –Zutter

Limoges - Tyson

Matteau – Zutter

Hemingway – Tyson

Hayden – Zutter

O’Hearne – Greenrose

Girard – Greenrose

Motion carried 4- Zutter, 2 Tyson, 2 Greenrose

AGENDA CHANGES

Assistant Mayor Matteau suggested moving the Arts Committee vote until after the second reading of the Ordinance.

Councilor Koloski clarified by asking if this should be placed under 10. (B)

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept the minutes of the April 24, 2024, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

MAYOR’S NOTES

Parks and Recreation are hosting a trip to see the Red Sox vs Washington Nationals this Saturday.

Stevens High School Student art exhibit will take place at the Claremont Opera House through May 7-24th.

Fiske Free Library is celebrating children’s book week, ends on May 12th.

The West Claremont Center of Arts will be hosting New Inca Sun.
May 16th 5p.m. to 7p.m. Baird Swift of the Haines Dairy Farm will be hosting a dairy talk on dairy operations at 3010 Grand Ave.
Stevens High School post grad 2024 committee is hosting a spring fling at the Claremont elks club on Friday May 17th.
Ashley Ferry Boat ramp will be closed starting May 13th for six weeks.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Manager Manale stated he will be deferring comments until Budget.

Councilor Koloski asked when DPW will start line striping. The City Manager replied, next week, with a full schedule to come out soon. Councilor Koloski also asked about the railing being put back into the Council Chambers. Manager Manale will be following up.

Councilor Hemingway asked about updating pictures on the City website, Manager Manale noted there is an update and a website presentation on the agenda tonight.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Conservation Commission

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Hayden to appoint Erin Graf Greenrose to Seat A2 on the Conservation Commission.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay –yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O'Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0 voice

Claremont Development Authority

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Koloski to nominate Allison Browning to Seat 8 on the Conservation Commission.

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Councilor Tremblay to nominate Candice Crawford to Seat 8 on the Conservation Commission.

Roll call:

Koloski – Browning

Tremblay – Crawford

Limoges - Browning

Matteau – Browning

Hemingway – Browning

Hayden – Crawford

O’Hearne – Browning

Girard – Browning

Motion carried Alison Browning 6-2

City Clerk, Gwen Melcher gave an update on RSA 669:1 Paragraph 3, “no town election shall be held in conjunction with the biennial election.”

Policy Committee

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Koloski to appoint Codi Raymond to Seat 4 on the Policy Committee.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Policy Committee Council Seat

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint Councilor O’Hearne for the open Councilor Seat of the Policy Committee.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Hayden to appoint Councilor Zutter for the open Councilor Seat of the Policy Committee.

Roll call:

Koloski – Zutter

Tremblay –Zutter

Limoges – O’Hearne

Matteau – Zutter

Hemingway – O’Hearne

Hayden – Zutter

O’Hearne – O’Hearne

Girard – Zutter

Motion carried 5-3 in favor of Zutter

Fiske Free Library Board of Trustees

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Tremblay to appoint Joshua Reyes to Seat A-2 on the Fiske Free Library Board of Trustees.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

CITIZEN’S FORUM

Mike Tetu, Ward 1, Shared continued concern over the Charter Amendment and would like to see the topic back on the agenda.

OLD BUSINESS

Ordinance 623 Arts & Historic Commission Alternate Seats Second Reading

CITY OF CLAREMONT – IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY-FOUR

ORDINANCE #623

The City of Claremont Ordains:

Section 1. Claremont Arts, History and Culture Resources Preservation Commission

Amend City Code Chapter 2, Article II, Division 11, Sect. 2-144, as follows:

Sec. 2-144 Structure of the Commission.

- (1) Composition. The Arts, History, and Culture Commission shall consist of 7 members, all of whom shall be residents of Claremont and shall be regular voting members. The Commission shall also include one (1) city councilor serving as an ex officio member with power to vote. In addition, there shall be up to 4 alternate members appointed. All regular and alternate members shall be persons who demonstrate significant interest or participation in the promotion and preservation of Claremont's arts, history, and cultural assets.
- (2) Qualifications. All members shall be residents of the City of Claremont. In reviewing the qualifications of all candidates for the Commission, the City Council shall consider his/her demonstrated interest and experience in, and knowledge of, arts, history, crafts, and culture and his/her ability to administer this Section consistent with the mission of the Commission. To the extent that such persons are available, the Council shall seek members with diverse backgrounds.
- (3) Appointments. The Arts, History, and Culture Commission members shall be appointed pursuant to Chapter 2, Article II, Division 1 of the City Charter for terms of 3 years. Some initial appointments (and subsequent appointments, when necessary) shall be for less than three years in order that the various terms be staggered.

Section 2. Prior Enactments Shall Not Be Superseded

Any adoptions and/or amendments to Chapter 2 of the City Code by action of the City Council prior to the adoption of this Ordinance are hereby preserved subject to the current amendments as presented by this Ordinance.

Section 3. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause, or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 4. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect and be enforced immediately upon passage.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteu and seconded by Councilor Tremblay to adopt Ordinance 623.

Assistant Mayor Matteau Read explanation of Proposed action into record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteu – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteu and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to nominate all eleven candidates to the Claremont Arts, History, and Culture Resources Preservation Commission.

Roll call:

Koloski – Dakin Burdick, Jill Chastenay, Felicia Dalke, Raymond Gagnon, Mark LaFontaine, David Messier, David Putnam

Tremblay – Je Austin, Jill Chastenay, Raymond Edwards, Mark LaFontaine, David Messier, David Putnam, Sophia Sushailo

Limoges – Dakin Burdick, Felicia Dalke, Raymond Gagnon, David messier, Joshua Nelson, David Putnam, Sophia Sushailo

Matteu – Dakin Burdick, Jill Chastenay, Raymond Gagnon, David Messier, Josh Nelson, David Putnam, Sophia Sushailo

Hemingway – Dakin Burdick, Jill Chastenay, Felicia Dalke, Mark LaFontaine, David Messier, David Putnam, Sophia Sushailo

Zutter - Dakin Burdick, Jill Chastenay, Felicia Dalke, Mark LaFontaine, David Messier, Joshua Nelson, Sophia Sushailo

Hayden – Je Austin, Felicia Dalke, Mark LaFontaine, David Messier, Joshua Nelson, David Putnam, Sophia Sushailo

O’Hearne – Je Austin, Dakin Burdick, Jill Chastenay, Felicia Dalke, Raymond Edwards, Raymond Gagnon, Mark LaFontaine

Girard - Dakin Burdick, Jill Chastenay, Felicia Dalke, Raymond Gagnon, Mark LaFontaine, David Messier, Joshua Nelson

Motion carried - Dakin Burdick (8), Jill Chastenay (7), Felicia Dalke (7), David Messier (7), Mark LaFontaine (6), David Putnam (6), Sophia Sushailo (6)

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to appoint 4 remaining candidates Je Austin, Raymond Edwards, Raymond Gagnon, and Joshua Nelson to the four alternate seats of the Claremont Arts, History and Culture Resources Preservation Commission

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter - yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to appoint Councilor Koloski as the Council Seat to the Claremont Arts, History and Culture Resources Preservation Commission.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter - yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

NEW BUSINESS

Ordinance 624- Taxi

Manager Manale presented the new Taxi Ordinance and explained there has been a problem within the City of Claremont with unlicensed Taxi’s. Currently the police can only issue a

\$100.00 fine. This new ordinance will provide a certain number of violations before the police can impound an unlicensed taxi.

CITY OF CLAREMONT – IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY FOUR

ORDINANCE #624

The City of Claremont Ordains:

Section 1. Taxicab Licensing

Amend City Code Chapter 21, Article II, Division 2, to add Sec. 21-48 as follows:

DIVISION 2. - LICENSES

Sec. 21-41. - Required.

No person shall operate, or cause to be operated, a taxicab within the city unless licensed as herein provided. The city manager is authorized to approve taxicab licenses in accordance with the provisions of this division. The taxicab license shall be issued by the city clerk upon approval of an application by the city manager and the applicant paying the fee prescribed by the city's current license, permit and service fee schedule.

(Ord. No. 295, § 1, 11-9-88)

Sec. 21-42. - Applications.

Application for a taxicab license shall be made on forms provided by the city, and shall set forth the name and address of the applicant, the trade name under which the applicant does or proposes to do business, where proposed stands and garages are to be located, the number of vehicles the applicant desires to operate with a clear description of each vehicle, and such other facts as the city manager may require.

(Ord. No. 200, § 3, 7-9-80)

Sec. 21-43. - Financial responsibility.

It shall be unlawful to operate a taxicab for hire or permit the same to be operated, nor shall any license be issued under this division, until and unless the applicant for license deposits with the city manager a policy or certificate of liability insurance for each taxicab for which a license is sought, such policy or certificate of liability insurance to be acceptable and approved by the city solicitor and issued by a company authorized to do business in the state indemnifying the applicant in the sum of at least twenty thousand dollars (\$20,000.00) for injury to one (1) person or forty thousand dollars (\$40,000.00) for injury to more than one (1) person and five thousand dollars (\$5,000.00) property damage in any one (1) accident, through or by the operation of the taxicab of the applicant; or deposits in lieu thereof the bond of a surety company authorized to do business in the state running to the city and

indemnifying persons who may be injured, or whose property may be damaged by the operation of such taxicab in the same amounts and conditioned that action may be brought thereon by any person so damaged against such surety company for the amount of such damage up to the amount named therein, such bond to be approved by the city solicitor. The policy of insurance or bond so deposited shall contain a clause obligating the company issuing the same to give ten (10) days' written notice before cancellation thereof to the city clerk. The license for the operation of such taxicab shall automatically expire upon the lapse or termination of such policy or bond.

(Ord. No. 200, § 4, 7-9-80)

Sec. 21-44. - Expiration.

Expiration of taxicab licenses issued under this division shall be on April 30.

(Ord. No. 200, § 5, 7-9-80)

Sec. 21-45. - Not transferrable.

No license for the operation of a taxicab shall be sold, transferred, or assigned. No license granted under this division shall apply to any taxicab except the particular one designated therein, by motor number, serial number or other identification.

(Ord. No. 200, § 6, 7-9-80)

Sec. 21-46. - Markings.

Every taxicab licensed under this division shall be conspicuously marked as a public taxicab and the license issued with respect to each taxicab shall be conspicuously posted therein and rates established by each taxicab company shall be conspicuously posted in each taxicab.

(Ord. No. 200, § 7, 7-9-80)

Sec. 21-47. - Suspension and revocation.

(a)The city manager is authorized to revoke any taxicab license if, after notice and hearing, he finds:(1)The person holding such license, or any principal owner, officer or manager of the firm or corporation holding the license, or the corporation holding the license, is convicted of any felony, any crime involving actual or threatened bodily harm, any sexual offense, substance abuse or a violation of this article.(2)One (1) or more drivers of taxicabs under that license are convicted of a series of traffic violations which make it reasonably probable that the holder of the license is not exercising the supervision necessary to protect the safety of persons hiring taxicabs operated under that license.(3)The applicant for the taxicab license has furnished false information to any city official or employee in the application for that license or pertaining to the drivers or operation of taxicabs under that license.(b)The city manager is also authorized to suspend, for not more than five (5) days, any taxicab license, if he has probable cause to believe that there are grounds to revoke the license.

Sec. 21-48

- A. The violation of any provision of this chapter shall be punished by a fine not to exceed \$100 per day, or the revocation of the taxicab vehicle license, taxicab driver's license, or a combination of any of the three.
- B. Each act of violation and every day upon which any such violation shall occur shall constitute a separate offense. The City may enjoin or abate any violation of this chapter by appropriate action. In addition to the penalty set forth in this chapter, if the court finds for the City, the City shall recover its costs of suit including reasonable experts fees, attorneys fees, and necessary investigative costs.
- C. The Police Department is hereby authorized to seize or immobilize any taxicab located within the City operating without a valid taxicab license. Upon such seizure or immobilization, the Police Department shall notify the owner of the vehicle of such seizure, the reason therefore, and of the place to which such vehicle has been removed or immobilized. The Police Department shall order the holding of any such vehicle for a period of not less than 10 days from the date of the required notification to the owner. During this period, the owner may redeem any such vehicle by correcting the violation of this chapter which led to such seizure. Any taxicab which is impounded or immobilized and which is not redeemed within 30 days of the date of notification as described in this section shall become the property of the City. Cost for towing, storage charges, associated attorneys fees and accumulated fines will be billed to the owner of the taxicab seized and must be paid in full before the release of the vehicle to the owner who shall be responsible for removing the vehicle from storage. The City will be held harmless for any damage occurring during the act of confiscation, transportation, storage, and/or immobilization of each vehicle.

Section 2. Prior Enactments Shall Not Be Superseded

Any adoptions and/or amendments to Chapter 21 of the City Code by action of the City Council prior to the adoption of this Ordinance are hereby preserved subject to the current amendments as presented by this Ordinance.

Section 3. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause, or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 4. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect and be enforced immediately upon passage.

Councilor Limoges asked if the violator will have a chance to get their vehicle back. Councilor Zutter asked if there were a certain number of violations. The City Manager explained there should be three violations. Councilor O'Hearne noted the language should change to ten business days due to weekend closures and holidays.

By consensus the City Council agrees to bring this back with changes.

Past Due Balances and Failed Scheduled Payment Memo

Director Martin explained the past due balances and failed scheduled payments. Director Martin noted training staff on active net, and training front desk personnel on how to approach a member with past due balances. Director Martin has been working with Attorney Feleen for a statute of limitations for past due balances, as well as looking into collection agencies.

Memo:

To: City Manager, Mayor, Assistant Mayor & Claremont City Council

From: Justin Martin, Director of Parks and Recreation

Date: 4/16/24

Re: Parks and Recreation Past Due Balances and Failed Scheduled Payments

As of January 1st, 2024, the Claremont Parks and Recreation Department (CPRD) has installed several new protocols to better handle the failed scheduled payments on individual accounts through our online registration software, ActiveNet. The first of which is making sure that our front desk staff better communicates with patrons who have past due balances when trying to access the CSBCC facility. Their responsibility is to address the balance with the customer upon trying to scan their membership card if a past due balance is present. The front desk staff member is to either collect the past due balance, or tell the member that they are not allowed in to the facility that day and until their account balance is resolved.

Secondly, we have staff making phone calls and e-mails to those individuals who may experience a failed scheduled payment. A failed scheduled payment occurs for a number of different reasons, the top 3 leading causes being, insufficient funds, do not honor/lost card and/or card issuer canceled card. These issues arise sometimes because a card was stolen and a member canceled their card but forgot it was linked to their membership payment, or it could just be a matter of poor budgeting in regards to insufficient funds, either way, a failed scheduled payment occurs often, especially when dealing with as many payment-plans for memberships as we see in our operation. Our Customer Service/Program Lead Position was moved from part-time to full-time on December 18th, 2023 to better handle these situations that arise. We now call all individuals, on each occurrence, when their scheduled payment fails and collect the past due amounts in a timely manner. Our front desk staff are being properly trained to better recognize members that carry past

due balances, and they are making sure they are addressing their past due balances in a timely manner. Since January 1st, 2024, we have not been adding to the debt amount that is owed to CPRD. Since the installation of our online registration software, ActiveNet, which dates back to December of 2004, individual accounts have held past due balances. The past due balance amount currently sits at over \$200,000.00. This ranges from CSBCC membership fees, youth sports program registrations fees, summer camp fees and even Kinder Fest fees which is a 10+ year old program that we used to operate out of Arrowhead Lodge. This large amount of past due balances that we have is a culmination of many years of a lack in staffing to address the issue once it arises. Currently, we are looking into a collection agency to help with collecting at least some of the total in past due balances that are owed to the city. We will have more information on that process once we meet and discuss further options with different companies.

Mayor Girard noted we were running ahead of schedule so the Council will go back to open Citizens Forum.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Sean Cantazarro, owner of Hope to Freedom Recovery homes in Claremont, stated wanting to start the conversation of Claremont becoming a recovery friendly workplace

Frank Sprague, Ward 2, wants the definition of nuisance to be revised for non-compliant wood boilers. Shared concern for obnoxious odors and health hazards.

Mayor Girard called for a break

Council reconvened and Mayor Girard announced it was brought to the Council's attention that in order to appoint a Councilor there needed to be a simple majority of the sitting Council; and four is not a majority, and noted a revote must take place and the City Clerk must swear in the new councilor again.

Mayor Girard suggested while waiting for the City Clerk to go forward with the JJ Creative Presentation.

JJ Creative Website Update

Nancy Meyer, the business development coordinator introduced Jim Tormey from JJ Creative who joined the Council meeting via zoom.

Mr. Tormey noted the last time the website was updated was in 2020, and the needs of the City has changed and it is time for an update.

Mr. Tormey gave examples of a visual refresh and walked the Council through all of the changes and new features on the Home page, Parks and Rec Page, and the Library page.

Council stated they liked the presentation and the new look of the website and thanked Mr. Tormey for his presentation.

Mayor Girard asked for a roll call vote for the open Council seat.

Roll call:

Koloski – Zutter

Tremblay – Zutter

Limoges - Tyson

Matteau – Zutter

Hemingway – Tyson

Hayden – Zutter

O’Hearne – Greenrose

Girard – Zutter

Motion carried in favor of Zutter (5), Tyson (2), Greenrose (1)

City Clerk, Gwen Melcher Swore in Mr. Zutter to the City Council as the Ward II City Councilor.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Limoges to nominate Councilor Zutter to the open Council seat on the Policy Committee.

Councilor O’Hearne noted the Council was jumping all over the agenda without specifying where at, and suggested mentioning the Council is voting again under appointments to boards and committees

Voice Vote:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter- yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – opposed

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-1 (1 opposed)

Councilor Koloski noted any votes taken prior to this would be vacated from the record, and suggested re-addressing the arts commission vote, Mayor Girard stated the Council can re-visit this at the end of the evening.

Resolution 2024-35 Donation from Baerbell Merrill – Public Hearing

Chief Wilmot explained resolution 2024-35.

RESOLUTION 2024-35

Baerbel Merrill Donation Acceptance

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the Claremont Police Department received a \$5,000 donation check from Mrs. Baerbel Merrill; and

WHEREAS Mrs. Merrill has previously donated money to the Claremont Police Department to be used in situations where Claremont residents are experiencing challenging situations; and

WHEREAS the City of Claremont has an established fund for handling such donations from Mrs. Merrill.

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED to accept the \$5,000 donation from Mrs. Baerbel Merrill with no impact on the tax rate.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(2/3 Vote Required)

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Tremblay to accept resolution 2024-35.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2024-36 VOCA Grant – Public Hearing

Chief Wilmot explained the VOCA Grant and introduced the ACERT Coordinator Stephanie Durkee.

RESOLUTION 2024-36

Department of Justice VOCA Grant

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City of Claremont, New Hampshire has been awarded a United States Department of Justice Victims of Crime Act (VOCA) Grant in the amount of \$80,000.00 for a one-year period to fund the position of ACERT Coordinator. This position facilitates the Adverse Childhood Experiences Response Team (ACERT) for the Greater Claremont Area; and

WHEREAS, if accepted, the City of Claremont, New Hampshire would have a \$20,000 matching requirement, of which \$15,460.00 would be from in-kind funding, and \$4,540 would be a cash match; and

WHEREAS, the matching funds will be absorbed in the FY25 Police Budget, thereby causing no additional impact on the tax rate.

WHEREAS the City would like to accept and expend the funds for their intended purpose;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that the City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or his designees to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to accept a grant in the amount of \$80,000.00 from the United States Department of Justice to fund the ACERT Coordinator position; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(2/3 Vote Required)

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept resolution 2024-26.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the Public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2024-37 COSSAP Amendment – Public Hearing

Chief Wilmot explained this is an extension, Council had previously accepted this grant, and additional monies have been awarded for work with recovery and noted this extension gives the PD options for non-traditional responses to the opioid crisis.

RESOLUTION 2024-37

**COSSAP Comprehensive Opioid, Stimulant, and Substance Abuse Site-base Program
Grant Extension**

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City of Claremont, New Hampshire has applied for and been awarded a COSSAP Comprehensive Opioid, Stimulant and Substance Abuse Site-base Program Grant through the NH Department of Justice with a Limitation of \$343,484.00; and

WHEREAS, the State of New Hampshire received a time extension on the original grant with an end date of September 30, 2025.

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED to accept and expend the sum of \$343,484.00 by September 30, 2025 for the Police Department, with no matching requirements and no impact on the tax rate.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(2/3 Vote Required)

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept resolution 2024-26.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing

Sean Cantazarro Ward 1, shared he had overdosed years ago and didn't have anyone to help him, and follow up is important and gives someone self-importance and hope to not do it again.

Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O'Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

BUDGET

Preliminary Budget Discussions

Manager Manale, started the budget discussions by presenting the 2025 proposed budget and gave a power point presentation.

Assessing

Assessor, Stephen Hamilton completed last year's twenty-two abatement requests, a lot of personal exemption and veteran tax credit requests. Assessing is dealing with tax payers and navigating them through programs that are available, while trying to maintain financial stability.

Mr. Hamilton noted that Whitney consulting has a long-term plan to restore the city position in assessing and reduce the consulting line.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to tentatively accept the Assessing Budget for \$ 239,329.00.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Welfare Budget

Director Sue Carr gave an overview of the Welfare Budget, and noted while challenges have increased the department remains a two-person department and used to be a four-person department. The absence of housing has impacted the budget like the overspend request last month.

Mayor Girard suggested adding \$ 25,000.00 to the budget making the total 471,252.00.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Limoges to tentatively accept the Welfare Budget for \$ 471,252.00.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Tremblay – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Library Budget

Director Grace gave an overview of Library and budget, and noted circulation numbers are up 20%. More Groups using the space, read to a dog program, chess club, and friends of the library group has been reinstated.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Tremblay to tentatively accept the Library Budget for \$ 437,873.00.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes
Tremblay – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Elections Budget

Finance Director,----- Nancy Bates noted there are two elections coming up in September and November.

Councilor Koloski asked about updating voter machines
Director Bates noted there is a capital reserve for FY26 for the machines.

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to tentatively accept the Elections Budget for \$ 24,630.00.

Roll call:
Koloski – yes
Tremblay – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Debt Retirement (Debt Service)

Director Bates stated the city is current with all bond payments and noted these are contractual obligations.

A motion was made by Councilor Tremblay and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to tentatively accept the Debt Retirement Budget for \$ 658,719.00.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Policy

Human Resources Director, Jamie Young gave a power point presentation to Council to explain part of the Policy budget. Director Young highlighted the increased healthcare costs, Merit increase and noted the increase to the minimum and maximum. Some accomplishments include Three director hires: Bates, Martin, and Warner. Director Young is hoping to retain staff, improve with a time and attendance software, and a personnel evaluation software program.

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to tentatively accept the Policy Budget for \$ 687,056.00.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

IT Budget

By consensus City Council agrees to have IT come back to Council under General Services at the Next Budget Council Meeting.

Outside Agency Request

CASA

Assistant Mayor Matteau noted two of her grandsons were in the foster system and were adopted, CASA helps kids in most vulnerable position, and they are only asking for \$ 1000.00.

Southwest Services

Keith Thibault, from Southwest services gave a presentation and requested City support match in the amount of \$30,000.00.

Meals on Wheels

Brenda Burns, from Meals on Wheels gave an brief overview and requested funding from City Council in the amount of \$10,000 for the residents of Claremont.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Tremblay to tentatively accept the outside agency Budget. \$ 50,000.00.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Hemingway noted the Policy committee tabled all items for the class 6 roads, to send back to planning and zoning, and currently working on fire alarm systems, and working on the code of conduct document.

Councilor Tremblay shared the HDC had a presentation for a building on Pleasant St.

Councilor Hayden updated that the EPA Steering Committee held a discussion of timelines, and concern of water coming out of the synergy site.

Mayor Girard asked to go back to Boards and Committees and wondered if the Council should re-do the vote for the arts commission.

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept the previous results of the Claremont Arts, History and Culture Resources Preservation Commission.

Roll call:

Koloski – opposed

Tremblay – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-1 (1 opposed)

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Assistant Mayor Matteau asked for more information about the furnace issue from Mr. Sprague.

Mayor Girard brought attention to Council Rule changes that will be in the next Council Packet. Rule 1- for regular council meetings, and rule 12 relative to the City solicitor.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:09 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to adjourn.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Tremblay – yes

Limoges – yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council